

Paradiem

The Morning Brief

AUGUST 28, 2026

Narrow Vindication

*Nvidia and Salesforce delivered the beats but the tape narrowed to a single sector as MRVL faded
AH and Warsh's Jackson Hole keynote lands 10:00 AM ET.*

S&P 500 (SPY) \$771.10 · ↑0.66%	NASDAQ (QQQ) \$721.11 · ↑1.37%	NVDA (POST-PRINT) \$227.98 · ↑8.74%	SECTORS GREEN 1 of 11 · XLK ↑3.16%	FEAR & GREED ~55 · Greed (CNN; drop crypto fallback)
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SECTION 01

Markets — Nvidia’s Blackwell Print and Salesforce’s Claudeforce Partnership Delivered the Beats, but Every S&P 500 Sector Outside Technology Closed Red as the Tape Narrowed to a Single-Factor Rally Into Chair Warsh’s Friday Jackson Hole Keynote

THE POST-PRINT RESPONSE FUNCTION LANDED TWO-SIDED ABOVE THE TICKER LEVEL — SPY ↑0.66% AND QQQ ↑1.37% CONCEALED A TAPE IN WHICH ONLY TECHNOLOGY ADVANCED AMONG THE ELEVEN S&P 500 SECTORS ON THURSDAY’S CLOSE

Per data drop, SPY closed ↑0.66% at \$771.10 with QQQ ↑1.37% at \$721.11 and DIA ↑0.19% at \$535.22 on Thursday, and the response function to Wednesday’s Nvidia after-close release delivered the marquee bid the sleeve had positioned for: per data drop, NVDA closed regular hours ↑8.74% at \$227.98 (session H \$230.47), TSM ↑2.30% at \$427.30, LRCX ↑1.82% at \$318.58, KEYS ↑1.23% at \$325.82, NXPI ↑1.21% at \$225.86, and CRDO ↑6.07% at \$240.24 as the AI-networking read compounded the sleeve tape. Per data drop sector composition, Tech XLK closed ↑3.16% at \$188.61 as the only S&P 500 sector to advance on the session — Energy XLE ↓0.22%, Financials XLF ↓0.65%, Utilities XLU ↓0.76%, Materials XLB ↓0.82%, Industrials XLI ↓0.85%, Real Estate XLRE ↓0.95%, Comm-Svcs XLC ↓1.07%, Discretionary XLY ↓1.09%, Healthcare XLV ↓1.13%, and Staples XLP ↓1.38% all traded red as the flow concentrated into the single-factor semiconductor-and-enterprise-software expression. For FCI positioning, the composition — the beat-and-raise NVDA reaction delivered the marquee bid while the balance of the tape faded broadly — reads as a narrow-breadth continuation rather than a broad-index re-rating, a construction that historically tends to leave the sleeve compounding into the next material catalyst rather than mean-reverting broadly.

NVDA POST-PRINT CLOSE	\$227.98 · ↑8.74% · session H \$230.47
SECTORS GREEN / TOTAL	1 of 11 · XLK ↑3.16% only
FCI TOP MOVERS	NOW ↑10.04% · FTNT ↑9.67% · CRDO ↑6.07%
MRVL REGULAR / AH	\$241.45 ↓1.49% · roughly ↓7.6% AH
TLT (20Y BOND)	\$83.13 · ↓0.20% (duration continues to fade)
TODAY 10:00 AM ET	Warsh Jackson Hole keynote

SALESFORCE DELIVERED THE SESSION’S WIDEST ENTERPRISE-SOFTWARE MOVE ON THE ANTHROPIC “CLAUDEFORCE” PARTNERSHIP AND A RAISED FULL-YEAR GUIDE — THE SLEEVE READ-THROUGH COMPOUNDED INTO SERVICENOW ↑10.04% AND THE CYBERSECURITY COMPLEX

Per Motley Fool, Yahoo Finance, and Seeking Alpha coverage of Wednesday’s after-close release, Salesforce (CRM — not held by FCI) reported fiscal Q2 revenue of approximately \$11.35 billion (approximately ↑10.8% year-over-year) and

adjusted EPS of \$5.90 versus consensus near \$3.27, and per the coverage, the company raised full-year fiscal 2027 adjusted EPS guidance to \$16.67–\$16.71 versus consensus near \$14.16 alongside the announcement of an integration partnership with Anthropic branded “Claudeforce” that integrates Anthropic’s Claude reasoning into the Agentforce platform; per the coverage, Agentforce ARR was cited as approximately ↑240% year-over-year, and per Yahoo Finance, the shares closed ↑22.6% on the session — the widest single-name enterprise-software move in the current window. Per data drop, ServiceNow (NOW, FCI growth sleeve) closed ↑10.04% at \$138.43 (session H \$139.32) — the FCI sleeve’s widest single-name mover on the session — and the cybersecurity complex compounded the read with FTNT (FCI growth sleeve) closing ↑9.67% at \$172.78 and CRWD advancing on its own after-close beat-and-raise per 24/7 Wall St coverage. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Claude-integration signal that reframes the enterprise-AI monetization trajectory alongside the NVDA compute-layer print — reads as consistent with the FCI “physical world matters” framing extending into the software-and-services layer where compute demand translates into deployable enterprise workloads.

MARVELL BEAT AND RAISED GUIDANCE BUT FADED APPROXIMATELY 7.6% AFTER-HOURS — THE SEQUENTIAL GROSS-MARGIN COMPOSITION AND THE GOOGLE CUSTOM-CHIP TIMING FRAMED THE REACTION FUNCTION AGAINST A 187% YEAR-TO-DATE RALLY INTO THE PRINT

Per Investing.com, TradingKey, and TS2 coverage of Marvell’s after-close release, MRVL (FCI growth sleeve) reported fiscal Q2 2027 revenue of approximately \$2.74 billion (approximately ↑36.5% year-over-year and roughly \$20 million above consensus) and adjusted EPS of \$0.94 versus consensus \$0.93, and per the coverage, the company guided fiscal Q3 to approximately \$3.15 billion (plus or minus 5%) of revenue and approximately \$1.10 (plus or minus \$0.05) EPS versus consensus near \$3.04 billion and \$1.08 — a beat-and-raise on both revenue and earnings. Per data drop, MRVL closed the regular session ↓1.49% at \$241.45 (session H \$254.60 — the print landed after the close), and per TS2 coverage of the after-hours reaction, the shares traded approximately ↓7.6% in extended hours despite the beat, with the sell-side commentary framing the reaction against a non-GAAP gross-margin midpoint compressing approximately 90 basis points sequentially and against the timing on incremental revenue from the previously announced Google custom-chip partnership. Per Investing.com and TradingKey coverage, MRVL had rallied approximately 187% year-to-date into the release, a positioning read that historically tends to compress the response function against expectations rather than fundamentals. For FCI positioning, the composition — a beat-and-raise print with a two-sided margin-and-timing detail against a heavy year-to-date positioning — leaves the semiconductor sleeve reading through NVDA’s broader compute-layer bid while the MRVL sleeve-specific expression narrows at the margin.

A tape that concentrates a marquee-print bid into a single sector while the balance fades tends to leave the sequence risk tilted toward the incremental communication catalyst rather than the print already released. Discipline over impulse.

Geopolitics — Chair Warsh Delivers His First Jackson Hole Keynote at 10:00 AM ET Under the “Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy” Framing, Ukrainian Drones Struck the Kuibyshev and Afipsky Russian Refineries Overnight, and the Iran-Oman Hormuz Corridor Discussion Continued Alongside the G20 Finance Meeting Iran-Sanctions Agenda

CHAIR WARSH’S FIRST JACKSON HOLE KEYNOTE LANDS THIS MORNING AT 10:00 AM ET UNDER THE “FINANCIAL INNOVATION: IMPLICATIONS FOR PAYMENTS AND POLICY” THEME — THE SELL-SIDE COMMUNICATION READ FRAMES BOTH THE SEPTEMBER RATE-DECISION DISTRIBUTION AND THE DIGITAL-ASSET COMPLEX RESPONSE FUNCTION

Per Kansas City Fed program schedule and per CNBC, TradingView, and TFTC coverage of the symposium framing, Chair Warsh delivers his first Jackson Hole keynote as Fed Chair this morning at approximately 10:00 AM ET under the theme “Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy” — the first time in the Jackson Hole symposium’s history that digital-payments and financial-technology sit at the center of the program. Per InvestingLive coverage of the Warsh communication track since May, the record has skewed toward shortened statements and explicit independence from market pricing, and per CNBC coverage of the July 29 FOMC press conference, market interpretation split — the prepared remarks read hawkish on the strict 2% inflation target while press-conference language was read as marginally dovish, sending long-term Treasury yields higher into that press cycle. Per data drop, TLT closed ↓0.20% at \$83.13 — extending a modest fade of Tuesday’s duration bid through Thursday and reading against a September rate-decision distribution that remains hold-weighted per prior CME FedWatch coverage cited in Wednesday’s brief. For FCI positioning, the composition — a first-keynote communication read from a Chair still calibrating market expectations against a payments-and-policy framing that historically tends to move the digital-asset complex — keeps the sequence risk broadly two-sided across the duration, digital-asset, and equity-multiple expressions into the release.

UKRAINIAN DRONES STRUCK THE KUIBYSHEV REFINERY IN SAMARA OBLAST AND THE AFIPSKY REFINERY IN KRASNODAR KRAI OVERNIGHT — CRUDE BOUNCED THURSDAY AND THE UKRAINE-RUSSIA REFINERY CAMPAIGN CONTINUES TO COMPOUND THE MIDDLE EAST PHYSICAL-SUPPLY VARIABLE

Per Kyiv Independent and Al Jazeera coverage of the overnight strikes, Ukrainian forces struck two Russian refineries in the overnight-into-August 28 attack cycle — the Kuibyshev refinery in Samara Oblast (approximately 800 kilometers from the border with a stated production capacity of approximately 7 million metric tons per year of gasoline and diesel) and the Afipsky refinery in Krasnodar Krai; per Russian Telegram coverage cited in the reporting, large-scale fires were confirmed at Kuibyshev and Samara Oblast Governor Vyacheslav Fedorishchev confirmed infrastructure damage, while Russia’s Defense Ministry claimed forces downed approximately 102 Ukrainian drones overnight including 21 over Samara Oblast and 18 over Krasnodar Krai. Per data drop, USO closed ↑2.09% at \$130.01 and BNO ↑2.31% at \$51.71 on Thursday — a modest bounce that recovered a fraction of the Iran-Oman-corridor-driven compression from earlier in the week and one that landed

before the overnight refinery strikes hit the tape. Per data drop headlines, Reuters characterized crude as on track for a weekly loss even as Iran tensions simmer, and per additional Reuters coverage, Iran diplomacy turned toward reopening the Strait of Hormuz. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Ukraine-Russia refinery campaign at the deep-strike range compounding on the still-open Middle East supply variable — keeps the FCI energy sleeve (CVX, CNX, OKE) sitting at the intersection of the geopolitical physical-friction floor and the near-term diplomatic negotiating window.

THE G20 FINANCE MEETING SETS IRAN SANCTIONS ON THE AGENDA ALONGSIDE GROWTH-AND-IMBALANCES DISCUSSION — TRUMP-REFINER-AND-FUEL-RETAILER MEETING SIGNALLED AS THE IRAN WAR BOOSTS GAS PRICES AHEAD OF MIDTERMS; THE TRUMP-XI 7.5% OVERCAPACITY TARIFF ADVANCES TOWARD THE SEPTEMBER 24 WASHINGTON SUMMIT

Per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop headlines, a US-hosted G20 finance meeting will target growth, global imbalances, and Iran sanctions per Treasury official commentary — a construction that keeps the multilateral enforcement perimeter in the sequence alongside the bilateral

Trump-Xi track. Per additional Reuters coverage cited in the data drop, President Trump signaled plans to meet with refiners and fuel retailers as the Iran war continues to lift gasoline prices ahead of the midterms — a domestic-policy read that continues to sit alongside the sanctions-and-diplomacy sequence. Per Bloomberg, Semafor, and Fortune coverage cited through the week, the administration continues to prepare an approximately 7.5% overcapacity tariff on Chinese goods designed to bring the aggregate US-China tariff burden to approximately the 20% ceiling Beijing has signaled as consistent with the current truce, with the

announcement engineered around the September 24 Washington summit between Presidents Trump and Xi; per Reuters coverage cited in the data drop, the Saudi civil nuclear cooperation package remains before Congress conditioned on Riyadh formally recognizing Israel. For FCI positioning, the composition — multilateral Iran-sanctions engagement, a domestic-supply signal from the White House, and a bilateral China tariff track advancing toward a September summit — extends the trade-and-geopolitical compound the sleeve has been reading through the balance of the third quarter and into the fourth.

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole Keynote Lands at 10:00 AM ET Under the "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy" Framing — The Sell-Side Communication Read Frames Both the September Rate-Decision Distribution and the Digital-Asset Complex Response Function. Per Kansas City Fed program schedule and per CNBC, TradingView, TFTC, and XTB coverage of the symposium framing, Chair Warsh delivers his first Jackson Hole keynote as Fed Chair this morning at approximately 10:00 AM ET under the theme "Financial Innovation: Implications for Payments and Policy." Per InvestingLive coverage, the Warsh communication track since May has skewed toward shortened statements and explicit independence from market pricing, and per prior CME FedWatch coverage cited in Wednesday's brief, the September rate-decision distribution remains hold-weighted with the cut-side tail compressing at the margin after the sticky core PCE print. Per data drop, IBIT closed ↑1.87% at \$45.29 and ETHA ↑1.18% at \$18.87 on Thursday — the digital-asset ETF expression firmed cleanly into the keynote positioning while MARA ↑5.79% at \$11.87 and HUT ↑2.51% at \$87.13 extended the miner-side bid; per data drop, HOOD closed ↑1.12% at \$109.76 as the fintech sleeve recovered a fraction of Wednesday's fade. For FCI positioning, the composition — digital-asset ETF firmness and miner-sleeve extension into the payments-and-policy keynote — keeps the sleeve compounding around the Warsh communication signal against both the duration read and the September rate-decision distribution.

2. Salesforce ↑22.6% on the Anthropic “Claudeforce” Partnership and Raised Full-Year Guide Read Cleanly Through to the FCI Enterprise-Software Sleeve — NOW ↑10.04%, FTNT ↑9.67%, With CRWD Adding to Its Own Post-Print Bid.

Per Motley Fool, Yahoo Finance, and Seeking Alpha coverage of the Wednesday after-close release, Salesforce (CRM, not held by FCI) reported fiscal Q2 revenue near \$11.35 billion and adjusted EPS \$5.90 versus consensus near \$3.27, raised full-year fiscal 2027 adjusted EPS guidance to \$16.67–\$16.71 versus consensus near \$14.16, and announced the “Claudeforce” integration partnership with Anthropic that embeds Claude reasoning into the Agentforce platform (Agentforce ARR cited as approximately ↑240% year-over-year); per the coverage, CRM closed ↑22.6% on the session. Per data drop, ServiceNow (NOW, FCI growth sleeve) closed ↑10.04% at \$138.43, Fortinet (FTNT, FCI growth sleeve) closed ↑9.67% at \$172.78 alongside CrowdStrike (CRWD, not held by FCI) advancing per 24/7 Wall St coverage of its own after-close beat-and-raise print; per data drop, the enterprise-cybersecurity read-through compounded the software-layer bid alongside the compute-layer NVDA print. For FCI positioning, the composition — a Claude-integration partnership reframing enterprise-AI monetization alongside cybersecurity beat-and-raise validation — extends the FCI “physical world matters” framing into the software-and-services layer.

3. Marvell Beat and Raised Guidance but Faded Approximately 7.6% After-Hours — The Sequential Gross-Margin Composition and the Google Custom-Chip Timing Framed the Reaction Function Against a 187% Year-to-Date Rally Into the Print.

Per Investing.com, TradingKey, and TS2 coverage of the MRVL after-close release, MRVL (FCI growth sleeve) reported fiscal Q2 2027 revenue of approximately \$2.74 billion and adjusted EPS of \$0.94 versus consensus \$0.93, and guided fiscal Q3 to approximately \$3.15 billion of revenue and approximately \$1.10 EPS versus consensus near \$3.04 billion and \$1.08 — a beat-and-raise across both metrics. Per TS2 coverage, the shares traded approximately ↓7.6% in extended hours despite the beat, with sell-side commentary framing the reaction against a non-GAAP gross-margin midpoint compressing approximately 90 basis points sequentially and against the timing on incremental revenue from the previously announced Google custom-chip partnership; per Investing.com, MRVL had rallied approximately 187% year-to-date into the release, a positioning read that historically tends to compress the response function against expectations rather than fundamentals. Per data drop, MRVL closed the regular session ↓1.49% at \$241.45 (session H \$254.60), which would place the pre-market read into today’s open modestly below Thursday’s close pending the cash-session confirmation. For FCI positioning, the composition — a beat-and-raise print with a two-sided margin-and-timing read against heavy year-to-date positioning — leaves the

semiconductor sleeve reading through NVDA’s broader compute-layer bid while the MRVL sleeve-specific expression narrows at the margin.

4. CRDO ↑6.07% Extended the AI-Networking Read Alongside NVDA and TSM — NXPI ↑1.21%, LRCX ↑1.82%, KEYS ↑1.23%; AMD ↓0.89% and QCOM ↑0.65% Held Steady as the Sleeve Response Function Bifurcated Around Direct-Compute Exposure.

Per data drop, Credo Technology (CRDO, FCI growth sleeve) closed ↑6.07% at \$240.24 — the widest single-name FCI semiconductor mover behind NVDA on the session — alongside TSM ↑2.30% at \$427.30 as the foundry-and-networking read compounded NVDA’s data-center commentary; per SeekingAlpha coverage cited in the data drop, sell-side commentary framed CRDO as entering its hardest test and paired the read with a Jackson Hole coverage note. Per data drop, LRCX ↑1.82% at \$318.58, KEYS ↑1.23% at \$325.82, and NXPI ↑1.21% at \$225.86 extended the broader sleeve bid at a more modest pace, while AMD closed ↓0.89% at \$476.67 and QCOM ↑0.65% at \$164.78 as the sleeve response function bifurcated around direct-compute-cycle exposure. For FCI positioning, the composition — the AI-networking-and-foundry sleeve compounding cleanly while more consumer-and-mobile-cycle exposures faded — keeps the FCI semiconductor thesis reading through the compute-demand vector rather than a broader semi-cycle re-rating.

5. Dividend-and-Cyclical Sleeve Faded Broadly — SYK ↓2.29%, ABT ↓2.20%, PCAR ↓2.08%, TOL ↓2.06%, GPC ↓2.00%, CAT ↓0.60%; The Defensive Rotation Read Reversed Cleanly on the Single-Factor Tech Bid.

Per data drop, the FCI dividend and cyclical sleeves faded broadly Thursday against the concentrated technology bid: SYK ↓2.29% at \$322.12, ABT ↓2.20% at \$111.59, PCAR ↓2.08% at \$126.54, TOL ↓2.06% at \$145.13, GPC ↓2.00% at \$136.70, CAT ↓0.60% at \$817.00, GD ↓0.51% at \$380.06, TEL ↓0.99% at \$203.00, and STLD ↓0.03% at \$235.84; per data drop sector composition, Healthcare XLV ↓1.13%, Staples XLP ↓1.38%, and Discretionary XLY ↓1.09% led the sector-level fade against the XLK ↑3.16% single-factor bid. For FCI positioning, the composition — near-universal fade of the balance of the FCI universe alongside the concentrated semiconductor-and-enterprise-software rally — reads as a single-session narrowness rather than a directional shift in the underlying thesis, and the sleeve breadth read remains a key input into the incremental September rate-decision-and-Warsh keynote sequence.

6. Precious-Metals Miner and Utility Complex Held Cleanly — AEM ↑0.65%, GLD ↑0.30%, SLV ↑1.92%, CEG ↑1.03%; The Physical-World Hard-Asset Read Recovered a Fraction of Wednesday’s Fade.

Per data drop, the precious-metals complex firmed at the margin with AEM (Agnico Eagle Mines, FCI growth sleeve) closing ↑0.65% at \$215.44, GLD ↑0.30% at \$422.60, and SLV ↑1.92% at \$62.77 — recovering a fraction of Wednesday’s debasement-bid fade; per data drop, the FCI utility complex held cleanly with CEG (Constellation Energy, FCI growth sleeve) closing ↑1.03% at \$282.41 alongside VST (Vistra, FCI growth sleeve) marginally ↓0.16% at \$139.81 and EIX ↓1.11% at \$73.68. Per data drop, FCX ↓0.73% at \$78.42 and CVX ↓0.22% at \$199.77 extended a modest fade in the copper-and-energy sleeve. For FCI positioning, the composition — a hard-asset firming against the utility-and-power framing holding — keeps the “physical world matters” expression intact through the sequence and consistent with the incremental-catalyst read into the Warsh keynote.

7. Carson’s SPY \$645.80 Support Remains Active — Thursday’s \$767.16 Intraday Low Left the Level Untouched; No New Levels Set.

Per levels.json, Carson’s active SPY support at \$645.80 remained untouched through Thursday’s \$767.16–\$772.36 SPY intraday range per data drop and now sits approximately 16.3% below the current tape at \$771.10. No active resistance levels are on the book following the April 14 breakout of the \$691.90–\$693.20 major zone (both hit that session). With Chair Warsh’s Jackson Hole keynote today at 10:00 AM ET, the MRVL after-hours fade to read against Friday’s open, the Cook litigation continuing on the substantive record, the September 24 Trump-Xi Washington summit, and the September FOMC meeting still ahead, the pre-committed FCI deployment discipline (70% of reserves at –25% drawdown, remaining 30% at –40%) continues to frame reactive positioning against any single-session gap through the sequence. Note: the data drop Fear & Greed reading of 73 “Greed” reflects the CNN endpoint falling back to the crypto index; per web coverage as of Thursday’s close, the CNN stock-market F&G reading sits approximately near 58 “Greed” and should be treated as approximate for this brief.

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